



Pale Cyst Nematode

Last Modified: August 22, 2025

The pale cyst nematode (*Globodera pallida*, PCN) is a soil-dwelling roundworm that feeds on the roots of high-value crops such as potatoes, tomatoes, and eggplants. PCN is native to South America and was discovered in Idaho in 2006. This pest can remain dormant and viable in soil for 30 years.



LM Dandurand, University of Idaho

PCN are microscopic cyst-forming nematodes. When a mated female dies, her body hardens and becomes a cyst that contains between 300 to 500 viable eggs. If PCN populations are left unchecked, they can reduce crop yields by 20 to 70 percent.

What To Look For

How To Prevent This Pest

How It Is Treated

When PCN is detected, it stops commerce in potatoes and nursery stock. It can seriously harm our agricultural production, environment, and economy. Here's what to look for:

- Cysts
 - Dead females (cysts) can be found on the roots and potato tubers. They can stay dormant for up to 30 years, while the eggs inside remain viable.
- Field damage
 - Stunted plants with yellowing leaves, wilting, and eventually plant death.

PCN Photo Gallery



Report Plant Pests and Diseases

Have you seen this pest or signs of pest damage? Immediately report your findings.

[Find your State plant regulatory official](#)

[Find your State plant health director](#)

Controlling Pale Cyst Nematodes

Expand All

Current Status	+
APHIS' Response	+
Regulatory Information	+
Information for Cooperators	+
Spread the Word	+
Program Updates	+
Final Environmental Documents	+

Contact Us

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Tools

- Agricultural Commodity Import Requirements (ACIR)
- Animal Care Public Search Tool
- APHIS eFile
- Phytosanitary Certificate Issuance and Tracking System (PCIT)
- Veterinary Export Health Certification System (VEHCS)
- Veterinary Services Process Streamlining (VSPS)

USDA Resources

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